

less skilled (land investments). He started putting together quick deals without careful evaluation. It wasn't that Bud was trying to deceive anyone. He was just trying to make a lot of money and make it fast. Indeed, the judge ruled that there came to be an inherent conflict between Bud's interests (putting together a "deal") and the interests of his clients.

Bear in mind what God's Word says about a get-rich-quick attitude. "A faithful man will be richly blessed, but one eager to get rich will not go unpunished" (Proverbs 28:20).

I said that Bud had violated two basic biblical principles in his finances. The first was having a get-rich-quick attitude. The second was ignoring the primary adviser the Lord had provided, his wife, Sandi.

IGNORING YOUR TOP ADVISER

I don't think I can stress this principle too strongly. It is dangerous for a husband or wife to ignore the principal adviser the Lord has given: a spouse. In His infinite wisdom, God created humankind as male and female. He didn't have to—after all, He did create some asexual creatures with no need of a mate or a friend. But I suspect they lead rather dull lives.

When you live with someone in a relationship as close as husband and wife, there are bound to be problems. Since opposites tend to attract, you may not agree about everything. In fact, you may never totally agree about anything. But that's okay, as long as you know how to work it out together and reach a reasonable compromise.

Bud's background made him a candidate for excesses in the area of finances. Often it is not the person from a wealthy background who is obsessed by success but rather the one from a modest or poor background. We all have the tendency to overcompensate for what we lacked as children.

I came out of a relatively poor background in a wealthy community, and I tend to store rather than spend. Fortunately, God blessed me with a wife who prefers to sit on real furniture, or I